MIL-B-43246C
31 March 1982
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-43246B
7 March 1977

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BINDING ASSEMBLY, SNOWSHOE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers one type and size universal snowshoe binding consisting of a toe strap, and a heel and instep strap.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

* 2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

V-T-285	-	Thread, Polyester
QQ-Z-325	-	Zinc Coating, Electrodeposited Requirements For
DDD-L-20	-	Label: For Clothing, Equipage, and Tentage (General Use)
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: US Army Natick Research and Development Laboratories, Natick, MA 01760 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8465

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MILITARY

MIL-B-543	-	Buckles, Tongueless and Web Strap
MIL-C-5040	-	Cord Nylon
MIL-W-5664	-	Webbing, Textile, Elastic, Cotton
MIL-H-9890	-	Hardware, Individual Load Carrying Equipment: and Hardware, Miscellaneous
MIL-L-11075	-	Loops, Strap Fastener
MIL-W-17337	-	Webbing, Textile, Woven, Tubular, Nylon
MIL-W-27265	-	Webbing, Textile, Woven Nylon Impregnated

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-751	-	Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147	-	Palletized Unit Loads
MIL-STD-1188	-	Commercial Packaging of Supplies and Equipment

DRAWING

US ARMY NATICK RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT LABORATORIES

2-10-61	-	Binding Assembly, Snowshoe

(Copies of documents required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Samples.

3.1.1 Guide samples. Guide samples are furnished solely for guidance and information to the contractor (see 6.3). Variations from the specification may appear in the sample, in which case this specification shall govern.

3.1.2 First article. When specified a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.2 and 6.5).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

* 3.2 Materials (see 6.6).

* 3.2.1 Webbing.

* 3.2.1.1 Webbing, elastic. The webbing for the keeper shall be white and shall conform to class 1, 1 inch wide of MIL-W-5664.

* 3.2.1.2 Webbing, woven nylon. The 1 inch and 2 inch wide nylon woven webbing shall conform to MIL-W-17337 except that the color of the webbing shall be natural.

* 3.2.1.2.1 Impregnation. Impregnation of webbing shall conform to class L treatment of MIL-W-27265 except that the breaking strength after accelerated aging shall be not less than 85 percent of the breaking strength after treatment and the requirements for flexibility shall not be applicable.

* 3.2.1.2.2 Flexibility. The treated webbing shall retain flexibility when tested at -65 ± 2°F as specified in 4.4.1.1.

3.2.2 Thread, polyester. Thread shall conform to type I or II, class 1, size FF, natural color (white) of V-T-285.

* 3.2.3 Cord, nylon. The nylon cord for the pull cord shall be white and shall conform to type II of MIL-C-5040.

3.2.4 Loop, strap fastener. The strap fastener loop shall conform to type III, style G of MIL-L-11075 or to type IV hardware of MIL-H-9890, except that the color of the enamel shall approximately match the color of the webbing specified in 3.2.1.2.

* 3.2.5 Buckle, 1 inch non-slip, quick release, pack suspenders. The 1 inch non-slip quick release buckle shall conform to type XIV of MIL-H-9890, except the color of the enamel shall approximately match the color of the webbing specified in 3.2.1.2.

3.3 Construction. The construction shall conform in all respects to Drawing 2-10-61 and shall be as specified herein.

3.3.1 Stitches, seams, and stitching. All stitches, seams, and stitchings shall be performed using stitch type 301 of FED-STD-751, with 6 to 8 stitches per inch.

3.3.1.1 Type 301 stitching. Ends of all stitching shall be backstitched not less than 1/2 inch except where ends are caught in other seams or stitching. Thread tensions shall be maintained so that there will be no loose or tight stitching and the lock will be imbedded in the materials sewed.

3.3.1.1.1 Repairs of type 301 stitching. Repairs of type 301 stitching shall be as follows:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

a. When thread breaks or bobbin run-outs occur during stitching, except pre-stitching, the stitching shall be repaired by restarting the stitching a minimum of 1/2 inch back of the end of the stitching. 1/

b. Thread breaks, or two or more consecutive skipped stitches or run-offs noted during inspection of the end item (in-process or end item) shall be repaired by overstitching. The stitching shall start a minimum of 1/2 inch in back of the defective area, continue over the defective area and continue a minimum of 1/2 inch beyond the defective area onto the existing stitching. Loose or excessively tight stitching shall be repaired by removing the defective stitching without damaging the materials and restitching in the required manner. 1/

1/ When making the above repairs, the ends of the stitching are not required to be backstitched.

3.3.1.2 Automatic stitching. Automatic machines may be used to perform any of the stitch patterns provided the requirements for the stitch pattern, stitches per inch, and size and type of thread are met; and at least three tying, overlapping or backstitches are used to secure the ends of the stitching.

3.3.1.3 Thread ends. All thread ends shall be trimmed to 1/4 inch maximum length.

3.3.2 Webbing, ends, cut. The cut ends of the webbing as indicated on Drawing 2-10-61 shall be fused prior to stitching or assembly. After fusing, the ends shall be free from frayed edges and loose fibers.

3.4 Finish. The finish coating of the buckles and loop shall be smooth, uniform dry finish without blisters, peeling, chipping or cracking. The finish shall be free from any area of no film, sag, run, drop or scratch.

3.5 Marking. The identification marking shall be applied in the locations shown on Drawing 2-10-61 and shall conform to type IV, class 5 of DDD-L-20 except that the marking medium may be blue and the legend shall consist of the letters "U.S.", the contractor's name and the contract number printed with characters a minimum of 1/4 inch in height.

* 3.6 Instructions. A clear legible instruction sheet shall be furnished with each pair of bindings. The instruction sheet shall contain the information shown on figures 1 thru 4.

* 3.7 Workmanship. The binding shall conform to the quality of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use own or any other facilities suitable for the

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

* 4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.2), it shall be examined for the defects specified in 4.4.3.1 and 4.4.3.2. The presence of any defect shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

* 4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Components and materials inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

* 4.4.1.1 Webbing flexibility testing. In addition to testing required by referenced documents, the treated nylon webbing shall be tested as follows for conformance to the requirement specified in 3.2.1.2.2. The webbing shall be brought to equilibrium under standard conditions and then placed in a cold chamber at -65 ± 2°F for 4 hours. Then, while still at -65 ± 2°F, the webbing shall be passed through a buckle as shown on figure 3. Stiffening of the webbing such that the webbing will not slide through the buckle end loops and locking mechanism shall be considered a test failure. Any test failure shall be cause for rejection of the lot of webbing. The sample unit shall be 2 feet of the treated webbing. The sample size shall be as follows:

Lot size (yards)	Sample size (No. of sample units)
800 or less	2
801 to 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

4.4.2 In-process inspection. Inspection shall be made at any point or during any phase of the fabrication process to determine whether the web strap buckle has been treated, plated, and enameled in accordance with 3.2.5 and whether material cut lengths and required operations are in accordance with specific requirements. Whenever nonconformance is noted, correction shall be made to the items affected and to the operation.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4.3 End item examination. The end item shall be examined in accordance with 4.4.3.1 and 4.4.3.2. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one binding assembly. The sample unit shall be one binding assembly.

4.4.3.1 Visual examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed below. The inspection level shall be II and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 6.5 major and 15.0 total (major and minor combined) defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Webbing	Any hole, cut, tear, or smash	X	
	Multiple floats		X
	Abrasion mark; slub, or broken end or pick		X
	Not latex impregnated finish on woven nylon webbing	X	
	Not uniform in color		X
	Not specified color		X
Hardware, general	Broken or malformed, corroded areas, burrs, or sharp edges	X	
	Finish omitted or not as specified	X	
	Any required component missing or improperly installed causing failure to serve intended purpose	X	
	Size or type not as specified	X	
	Area of no finish		X
Open seams	Less than 1/2 inch		X
	1/2 inch or more	X	
	NOTE: A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken or when two or more consecutive skipped stitches or run-offs occur.		
Run-offs	(See "open seams")		
Stitch type	Wrong stitch type	X	
Stitch tension	Loose, resulting in loose top or bobbin thread; tight, resulting in excessive puckering of fabric on seam		X

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Stitches per inch	One less than minimum specified		X
	Two or more less than minimum specified	X	
	One or more in excess of maximum specified		X
	NOTE: Variation in the number of stitches per inch caused by the operator speeding up the machine and pulling the webbing in order to sew over heavy places or heavy seams, or turning corners shall be classified as follows: (a) Within the minor defect classification - no defect (b) Within the major defect classification - minor defect		
Thread breaks	Not overstitched as specified		X
	NOTE: Thread break not backstitched or overstitched shall be classified as an open seam.		
Ends of stitching (not held down by other stitching or turned under in a hem)	Not backstitched	X	
	Backstitched less than 1/2 inch		X
	Not secured as specified when stitching is performed on an automatic machine		X
Box stitching	Incomplete:		
	- One row of stitching omitted		X
	- Two or more rows of stitching omitted	X	
Stitching	Any row of stitching missing (except box stitching)	X	
Stitching margin	Not as specified		X
Components and assembly	Any component or required operation omitted or not as specified (unless otherwise classified herein)	X	
	Mend, darn, patch, or splice	X	
	Needle chew		X
	Ends of straps not cut as specified		X

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Cut end of webbing	Not fused (when applicable)	X	
	Fused but contains frayed edges or loose fibers		X
Cord	Ends not seared	X	
	Knot not securely tied at each end	X	
Thread ends	Not trimmed to 1/4 inch or less		X
Identification marking	Missing	X	
	Not type specified		X
	Not size specified		X
	Not in specified location		X
	Incomplete, misspelled, or illegible		X

4.4.3.2 Dimensional examination. The end item shall be examined for conformance to the specified dimensions. Any measurement deviating from the specified dimension shall be classified as a defect. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL shall be 10.0 defects per hundred defects.

* 4.4.4 Packaging inspection. An inspection shall be made to determine that preservation, packing, and marking requirements comply with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged with the exception that is need not be closed. Examination of closure defects listed below shall be made on shipping containers fully packaged. The lot size shall be the number of containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

Examination	Defect
Marking:	
Applicable to shipping container and polyethylene bagged unit pack	Missing; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Applicable to polyethylene bagged unit pack	Not black. Not on bag or white paper label.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Examination	Defect
Instruction sheet	Missing, incomplete, or illegible.
Materials	Any nonconforming component; component missing, damaged, or otherwise defective.
Workmanship	Open and noncontinuous heat seal and closure of polyethylene bag. Excess air not expelled from within the polyethylene bag. Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, improper taping, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling. Bulged or distorted container.
Content	Number of snowshoe bindings per shipping container is more or less than required.

4.4.4.1 Palletization examination. An examination shall be made to determine that the palletization complies with section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load fully packaged. The lot size shall be the number of palletized unit loads in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units.

Examination	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirement.
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified. Interlocking of loads not as specified. Load not bonded with required straps as specified.
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limit.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

* 4.5 Flexibility of webbing test. The webbing shall be brought to equilibrium under standard conditions. The webbing shall then be placed in a cold chamber at -65 + 2°F for 4 hours. At the end of this exposure time, the webbing while still at -65 + 2°F shall be passed thorough a buckle as shown in figure 3. Stiffening of the webbing such that the webbing will not slide through the buckle end loops and locking mechanism shall be considered a test failure.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. PACKAGING

* 5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.1.1 Level A. Two complete bindings and instruction sheet shall be compactly arranged and unit packed in a close-fitting clear polyethylene film bag. The polyethylene film shall be 0.00125 inch (± 25 percent) thick. All seams and closures shall be effected by heat sealing. Prior to or during final closure operation, excess air within the bag shall be expelled.

5.1.2 Commercial. The bindings and instruction sheet shall be preserved in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.2.1 Level A packing. Eighty pairs of bindings, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, grade V2s, of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.4.

* 5.2.2 Level B packing. Eighty pairs of bindings, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275, of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class domestic, variety SW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Each container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.4.

5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant shipping container. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.4.

5.2.3 Commercial packing. Bindings, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), bindings, packed as specified, shall be palletized in accordance with load type I of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L. Pallet patterns shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the pallet patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern intended to be used shall be submitted to and approved by the contracting officer prior to its use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or MIL-STD-1188, as applicable.

5.4.1 Polyethylene bag. Prior to heat-sealing (see 5.1.1), a white paper label containing the information specified in 5.4 in legible and indelible black letters and numerals shall be placed inside each bag. The label shall be placed so that it can be read through the bag. As a substitute for the label, the information may be printed or stamped on each polyethylene bag.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The binding is intended to be used with the magnesium trail snowshoe. The binding will accommodate either a right or left shoe or boot.

* 6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) When a first article is required (see 3.1.2).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) When weather resistant fiberboard is required for level B shipment (see 5.2.2.1).
(e) When palletization is required (see 5.3).

6.3 Samples. For access to samples, address the procuring activity issuing the invitation for bids.

6.4 Sources of supply. Sources of supply for the web strap buckle specified in 3.2.5 are as follows:

Manufacturer	Manufacturer's part No.
North & Judd Mfg. Co. 699 Middle Street Middletown, CT 06457	6105
Brookside Mfg. Co. Dublin Road Southberry, CT 06488	Sp453
Covert Mfg. Co. 517 Watervlit St. Troy, NY 12181	S-0105L

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

* 6.5 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of DAR 7-104.55. The first article should be a preproduction sample, consisting of one snowshoe binding assembly. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

* 6.6 Recycled material. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of the specification.

6.7 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - NU
Air Force - 99

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC
DSA - CT

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8465-0784

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS

THE BINDING SHALL BE ATTACHED TO THE SNOWSHOE IN THE LOCATIONS SHOWN BELOW.

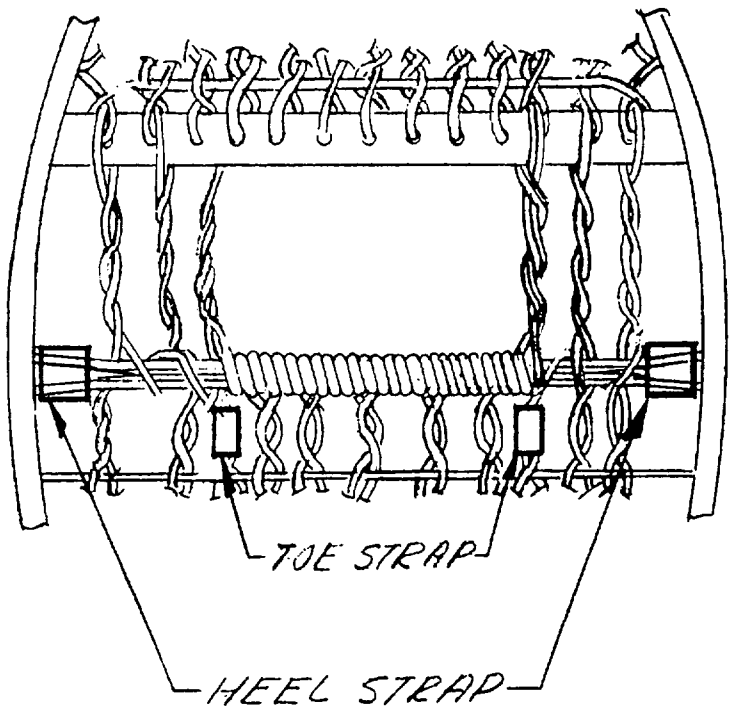


FIG-1

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

THE TOE STRAP IS ATTACHED AS SHOWN BELOW.

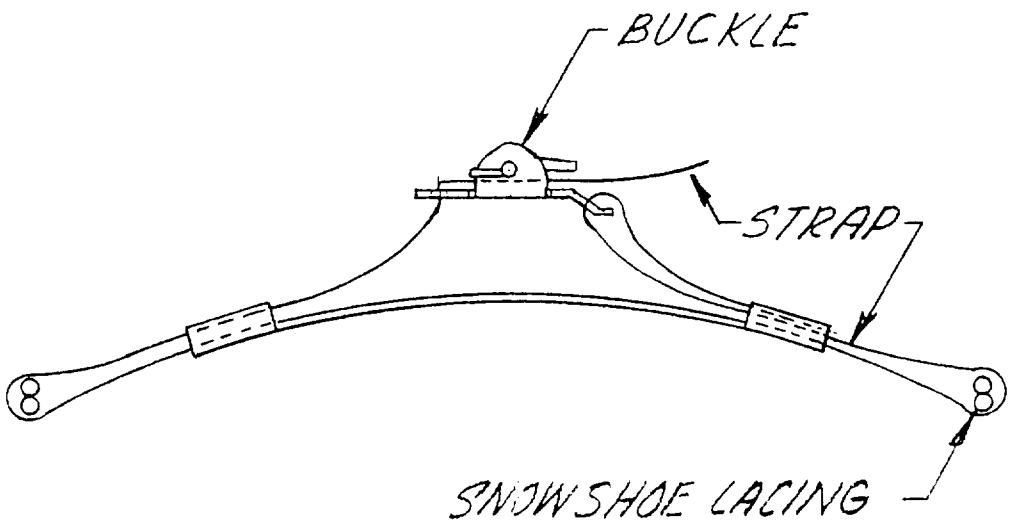


FIG-2

2-10-97 SHT 20F4

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

THE HEEL STRAP IS THREADED THROUGH THE ATTACHMENT BUCKLES AND AROUND THE SNOWSHOE LACING AS SHOWN BELOW. THE EXCESS STRAP MAY BE TUCKED IN THE ELASTIC KEEPER PROVIDED.

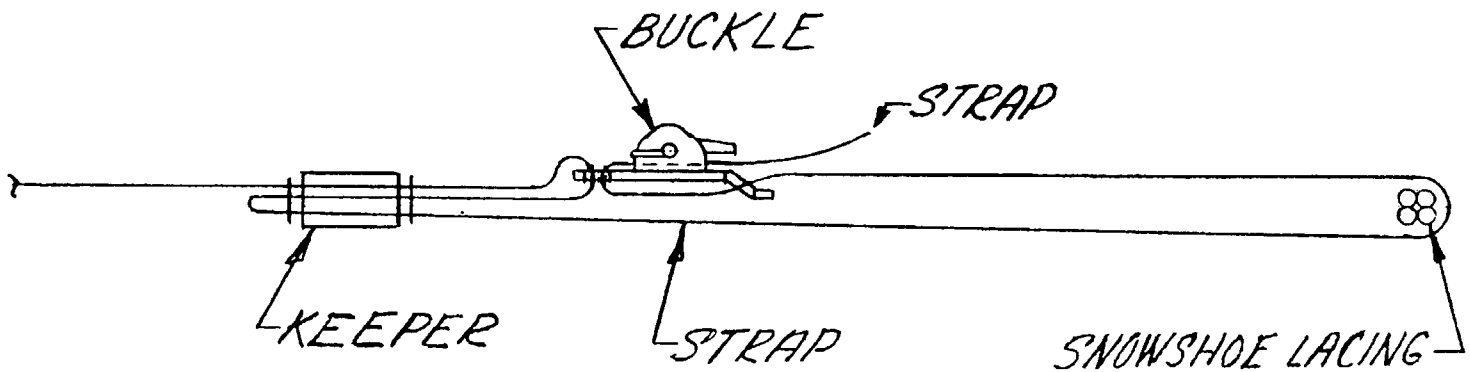


FIG-3

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

THE ANKLE STRAP IS THREADED THROUGH THE BUCKLE FOR SECURING THE BOOT AS SHOWN BELOW.

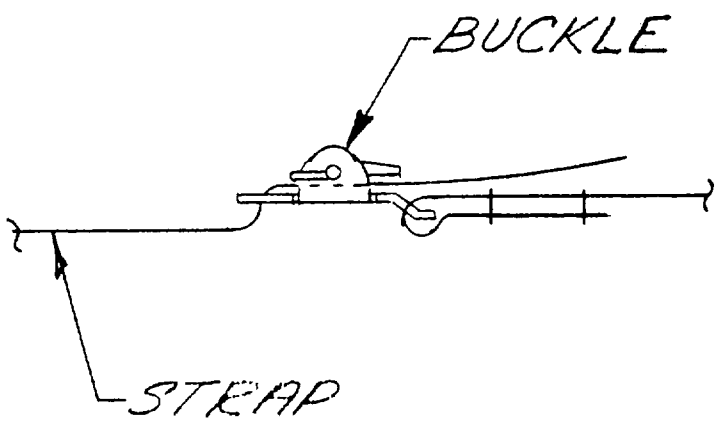


FIG-4

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currenversion before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS: This form is provided to solicit beneficial comments which may improve this document and enhance its use. DoD contractors, government activities, manufacturers, vendors, or other prospective users of the document are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity. A response will be provided to the submitter, when name and address is provided, within 30 days indicating that the 1426 was received and when any appropriate action on it will be completed.

NOTE: This form shall not be used to submit requests for waivers, deviations or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER *(Number)* AND TITLE

MIL-B-43246C Binding Assembly Snowshoe

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS OF SUBMITTER

☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER

1. ☐ HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE? ☐ IS ANY PART OF IT TOO RIGID, RESTRICTIVE, LOOSE OR AMBIGUOUS? PLEASE EXPLAIN BELOW.

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING

B. RECOMMENDED WORDING CHANGE

C. REASON FOR RECOMMENDED CHANGE(S)

2. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address — Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO.

DATE

DD FORM 1 OCT 76 1426 EDITION OF 1 JAN 72 WILL BE USED UNTIL EXHAUSTED.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

)LD

EPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
NALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

NO POSTAGE
NECESSARY
IF MAILED
IN THE
UNITED STATES

BUSINESS REPLY CARD

FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO. 12062 WASHINGTON D. C.

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

Commander
US Army Natick Research and Development
Command
ATTN: DRDNA-ES
Natick, MA. 01760

:LD

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.